

# Legal and Ethical Aspects of Nursing

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# Chapter 2: four ideas to connect

## Regulation of practice

Use the nurse practice act, board rules, facility policy, and standards of care to define safe practice.

## Liability prevention

Follow policy, report changes promptly, document accurately, and seek help before an unfamiliar task.

## Ethical principles

Use autonomy, beneficence, nonmaleficence, justice, fidelity, and veracity in patient-centered decisions.

## Rights and reporting

Respect advance directives and use the chain of command when care appears unsafe or unethical.

# Put the chapter into safe practical nursing care

## Safe care stays inside scope and protects patient rights.

Confirm that the task is authorized, that the patient understands and agrees, and that privacy is protected. Question unclear or unsafe directions and report concerns through the correct chain of command.

- ✓ Confirm scope and supervision
- ✓ Protect privacy
- ✓ Respect informed choices
- ✓ Question unsafe directions
- ✓ Document facts promptly

RECOGNIZE → ACT → REPORT

**Protect the right.  
Prevent the harm.  
Report the concern.**

Before moving on, explain the cue, your immediate action within scope, and the facts you would report.